Lesson plan · for the teacher

Updates close the door

Cyber security · Level 2 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk; A green and a red card for each pupil (or squares of paper); Six situations written on a sheet for the teacher

Learning goals

- Explain what a security update fixes.
- Decide when it is safe and sensible to install an update.
- Spot software that is risky to install.

Activity: Update or not?: Green card, red card

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the story: the lock on the school store room is broken, and everyone in town has heard. Ask pupils: when should the school fix it, and why not next month?
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that apps have hidden mistakes, and some are holes. An update is the new lock. Once a fix is out, criminals study it and look for phones that haven't installed it. Draw a phone with a hole and a patch.
3. Green card, red card (15 min): Read the six situations one at a time. Pupils hold up green for safe or red for risky. Ask two pupils each time to explain their card.
4. Share (7 min): In groups, pupils write one short rule for the phones at home, such as "Let updates run at night on the charger." Groups read their rules aloud.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one thing an update does and one thing they won't install. Read a few aloud.

Write six situations on a sheet: an update offered during an exam; a phone whose security date is two years old; a cracked game from a friend; an app from a link in a chat; an update set for tonight on the charger; a "free full version" of a paid program. Cut a green and a red square of paper for each pupil.

Discussion

- Why do criminals study a new update?
- When is the best time for a phone to update?
- What would you do with a computer that no longer gets updates?

Exit ticket

- One thing an update does + one thing I won't install.

Try it at school tomorrow
Play "Update or not?": read out six short situations, such as an update offered during an exam, a phone that stopped getting fixes, a cracked game from a friend, an app from a link in a chat, an update set for tonight on the charger, and a "modded" app. Pupils hold up a green card for safe and a red card for risky, and explain why.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **A colleague posts in the staff group: "Free full version of the timetable program, no licence needed!" Safe or risky?**

◯ Risky: cracked software often hides malware ◯ Safe, if the antivirus doesn't complain

◯ Safe: a colleague shared it

2 **Which of these keep a school phone protected?**

☐ Installing apps only from the official store ☐ Automatic updates for the system and the apps

☐ Restarting when the phone asks after an update

☐ Waiting a few months to see whether an update is safe

☐ Installing the "cleaner" app a pop-up recommends

3 **If a phone works fine, it doesn't need security updates.**

◯ True ◯ False

4 **Complete the sentences.**

A security update _____ a hole in the code. A device past its _____ date gets no more fixes, so keep it away from _____ .

Word bank: pupils' records · purchase · opens · closes · the charger · end-of-support

5 **Match each situation to the safest response.**

An update pops up in the middle of a lesson	• • • •	Don't install it; use the official store
The phone's security date is two years old	• • • •	Let it run tonight on the charger
A friend sends a "modded" app file	• • • •	Scan it before opening any file
A USB stick from the cyber café	• • • •	Keep it off sensitive work and plan to replace it

✎ **Think of the devices you use for school: your phone, a laptop, the office computer. Which one is most likely to be missing updates, and what will you do about it this week?**

Check your answers

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1 **Risky: cracked software often hides malware**

Cracked copies are a favourite way to spread malware, whoever forwards them: your colleague means well but can't see what's inside.

2 **Automatic updates for the system and the apps; Restarting when the phone asks after an update; Installing apps only from the official store**

Automatic updates close holes quickly, a restart makes many fixes take effect, and the official store checks apps before you get them.

3 **False**

Security holes are invisible: a phone can work perfectly while a known hole lets criminals in.

4 **A security update closes a hole in the code. A device past its end-of-support date gets no more fixes, so keep it away from pupils' records.**

An update closes a hole. After the end-of-support date, new holes stay open, so the device shouldn't handle sensitive work like pupils' records, email or banking.

5 **An update pops up in the middle of a lesson — Let it run tonight on the charger**
The phone's security date is two years old — Keep it off sensitive work and plan to replace it
A friend sends a "modded" app file — Don't install it; use the official store
A USB stick from the cyber café — Scan it before opening any file

Each answer keeps you protected without stopping your work: updates at a quiet time, sensitive work only on supported devices, apps from the store, and a check before opening shared files.